
THE STANDING RULES OF THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH OF THE PHILIPPINES

ARTICLE I NAME

The name of this body shall be called the GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH OF THE PHILIPPINES, *which shall be referred to as GAPCP, General Assembly, or simply the Assembly.*

ARTICLE II PURPOSE

This Standing Rules shall be the complementary rules of the *Book of Church Order (BCO) or Standards of the GAPCP*, and shall be used to *direct the meeting* of the General Assembly. *The ultimate authority of any court of the church rests in God alone as revealed in His Word. It is the responsibility and privilege of his ministers and elders in His church to submit to Him and His Word in the work of the General Assembly.*

ARTICLE III MEETINGS

1. **STATED MEETING:** The GAPCP shall hold its annual assembly meeting, otherwise termed as General Assembly, on the *third Tuesday and ensuing days* of October at a place, date and time determined by the previous stated meeting.
2. **EMERGENCY MEETINGS:** Any emergency or special meeting may be held upon *the call of the GAPCP Executive Committee, through the GA Moderator*. Notice of time, place and purpose of such meeting shall be given at least *ten (10) days* in advance. *No other item other than what was announced in the call shall be discussed in the special meeting.*
3. **QUORUM:** Any twenty or more of the delegates, *of which 10 are Ministers and 10 are Elders at the least*, being met on the day at the place appointed shall be quorum for the transaction of business. *(See Article 19.1 Transitory Articles)*
4. **DOCKET:** *A proposed docket setting forth the order of business shall be prepared by the GAPCP Executive Committee for stated meetings and sent to all clerks of Presbyteries, Ministers, Elders and churches two (2) weeks before the meeting. A docket shall be adopted by the General Assembly by majority vote, and may be amended at any time during the meeting by two-thirds (2/3) vote.*
5. **PLACE OF MEETING:** *The General Assembly, for each annual October stated meeting, may receive invitations from churches or Presbyteries to host the coming year's stated meetings. If an invitation for stated meeting is not received/accepted, the Executive Committee shall undertake to secure a venue. When a church designated to host a future meeting is later unable to do so, the church shall notify the GAPCP Recording Clerk as soon as possible. The Executive Committee shall immediately undertake to secure another venue. If two or more churches or Presbyteries submit invitations to host the General Assembly for the same year, priority will be given to the Presbytery or church which has never hosted a General Assembly or which hosted a General Assembly the greatest number of years ago.*

ARTICLE IV MEMBERSHIP

1. The General Assembly shall consist of Ministers and the Elders who have been commissioned by their respective presbyteries, *namely one minister and one elder for every 200 baptized members of the Presbytery. (BOG Chapter 11-2) (See Article 19.2. Transitory Articles).*
2. Every presbytery should elect its commissioners and submit the list of them to the General Secretary at least one (1) month ahead of the annual meeting of the General Assembly.
3. *The Executive Committee of Presbyteries shall be responsible that no inactive Minister(s) shall be delegated by the respective Presbyteries as commissioner(s) to the General Assembly.*
4. The inactive Minister shall be defined as follow:
 - 4-1. One who is undergoing language study in case of a foreign missionary.
 - 4-2. One who has no specific ministry within his respective presbytery.
 - 4-3. One who is under discipline.
 - 4-4. One who is on furlough or study leave.
 - 4-5. One who has not attended his respective presbytery meeting for two consecutive times without valid reason
 - 4-6. One who has not paid his dues to *GAPCP*.

ARTICLE V THE OFFICERS OF THE ASSEMBLY

1. The Officers of the General Assembly shall consist of a *General Secretary*, a Moderator, a Vice Moderator, a Recording Clerk, *and* a Treasurer.

2. The General Secretary

- 2-1. The General Secretary shall be the *Stated* Executive Officer of the *GAPCP*, and shall serve a term of two (2) years on a full-time basis. *He may be chosen to serve for another term according to the pleasure of the General Assembly. (BOG Chapter 19-5)*
- 2-2. He shall receive full compensation and shall have the following duties:
 - 2-3.1 To represent the *Denomination* in all its internal and external affairs *not related with the activities of the Corporation*.
 - 2-3.2 To visit the Presbyteries, particular churches and mission fields within the bounds of the *GAPCP*.
 - 2-3.3 To transact business for and in behalf of the *GAPCP*, in *certain situations* involving monies and property, with the concurrence of 2/3 votes of the BOT.
 - 2-3.4 To oversee the affairs of the Denomination.
 - 2-3.5 To implement the decisions *and resolutions* of the General Assembly.
 - 2-3.6 To administer the headquarters of the *GAPCP*.

- 2-3.7 To sign all pertinent documents in behalf of the *GAPCP not related with the activities of the Corporation.*
 - 2-3.8 To coordinate with the Recording Clerk for the publication of Minutes, Journals, and other declarations of the General Assembly.
 - 2-3.9 To call for special meeting(s) with the Moderators of Presbyteries and Chairman of Standing Committees as it may deem necessary. He shall be the presider of the said meeting(s) and shall submit the resolutions to the Body for ratification.
 - 2-3.10 *In instances that both the treasurer and the recording clerk are not present, and presbyteries, churches, or individuals desire to give their contributions to the GAPCP, the General Secretary shall have authority to receive contributions from such and to issue receipts. He shall then immediately contact the treasurer and report the contribution.*
- 2-3. Qualifications of the General Secretary
- 2-4.1 *He must be a Minister or an Elder in the General Assembly of the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines.*
 - 2-4.2 *He must be conversant with the history and distinctives of the Presbyterian and Reformed tradition and in particular of the history and distinctives of GAPCP.*
 - 2-4.3 *He must have a competent knowledge of the standards of GAPCP.*
 - 2-4.4 *He must be loyal to the standards of GAPCP and be able to fairly represent the action of the General Assembly.*
 - 2-4.5 *He must be able to work in a capable, sensitive, manner with persons who are of responsibility in the GAPCP organization structure.*
- 2-4. The Minister or Elder who has been elected to the office of the General Secretary shall be granted the official leave of absence for the period of his term by the particular church in which he is the duly installed Pastor, and shall be reinstated to his pastoral charge upon the completion of his tenure or termination of his office as General Secretary, whenever applies, he shall, however, remain to be the Moderator of the session where he belongs.

3. The Moderator

- 3-1. The Moderator shall be the Presiding Officer of the General Assembly *meeting* and shall serve a term of *one (1) year until a successor is inducted.*
- 3-2. *The Moderator shall also serve as the President of the Corporation.*
- 3-3. *The Moderator shall have the following duties:*
 - 3-3.1 *Prepare the docket of the General Assembly in coordination with the General Secretary and the Recording Clerk.*
 - 3-3.2 *Arrange for the worship service in coordination with the host church and ensures that the worship service can be conducted within the one hour limit.*
 - 3-3.3 *Encourage committee chairmen to ensure that the work of their committee is done well.*

- 3-3.4 *Preserve order, to convene and adjourn the judicatory, and to direct operations according to the rules of the church.*
- 3-3.5 *Endeavor to conduct business before the Assembly to a speedy and proper result.*
- 3-3.6 *Propose to the Assembly every subject of deliberation that comes before it.*
- 3-3.7 *Propose what appears to him the most regular and direct way of bringing any business to issue.*
- 3-3.8 *Always announce the names of members to whom he gives the privilege of the floor, prevent members from improperly interrupting each other, and require them, in speaking, always to address the chair.*
- 3-3.9 *Prevent the speaker from deviating from the subject.*
- 3-3.10 *Silence those who refuse to observe order.*
- 3-3.11 *When the deliberations are ended, shall put the question and call a vote.*
- 3-3.12 *In all questions shall give a clear and concise statement of the question being voted upon, and the vote being taken, and declare how the question is decided.*
- 3-3.13 *Keep notes of the several articles of business which may be assigned for particular times, and to call them up at the time appointed.*
- 3-3.14 *Speak to points of order in preference to other members; and shall decide questions of order, subject to an appeal to the judicatory by any two members. When in doubt on a point of order, the Moderator may submit the question to the Assembly for decision.*
- 3-3.15 *When a vote is taken and the Assembly be equally divided, he shall possess the casting vote. If he be not willing to decide, he shall put the question a second time; and if the Assembly be again equally divided, and he decline to give his vote, the question shall be lost.*
- 3-3.16 *He shall be the custodian of the gavel and shall, upon election of the Moderator of the succeeding Assembly, present the gavel to him.*
- 3-3.17 *He shall studiously learn the role and responsibilities of a Moderator, and be knowledgeable of the Constitution, Standards and Standing Rules of the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines, and of the current Parliamentary Procedures.*
- 3-3.18 *Always have a copy at hand of the following documents for reference and guide during deliberations:*
 - a. *The Westminster Standards (the Confession of Faith, the Larger catechism and the Shorter Catechism)*
 - b. *The GAPCP Book of Church Order (Form of Government, Directory of Worship and The Book of Discipline)*
 - c. *Standing Rules of GAPCP*
 - d. *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised (current edition)*
- 3-3.19 *The Moderator shall preside at all sessions of the Assembly except when he may invite the Vice-Moderator to act temporarily as the presiding officer.*

4. The Vice Moderator

- 4-1. The Vice Moderator shall be the Assistant Presiding Officer of the GAPCP.
- 4-2. *The Vice-Moderator shall be the Vice-President or Vice-chairman of the Board of Trustees of the Corporation.*
- 4-3. The duties of the Vice-Moderator shall be to:
 - 4-3.1 Fill the chair of the Moderator in case of absence of the latter or when the chair is relinquished to him. *The Moderator may request the Vice-Moderator to preside and to assist in the performance of other functions of the Moderator during and following the General Assembly.*
 - 4-3.2 Represent the assembly at the request of the Moderator. When the Vice-Moderator serves in this capacity, all those duties incumbent on the Moderator shall be expected of him.
 - 4-3.3 *Studiosly learn the role and responsibilities of a Moderator, and be knowledgeable of the Constitution, Book of Church Order and Standing Rules of the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines, and of the current Parliamentary Procedures.*
 - 4-3.4 He shall serve for one (1) year and shall automatically assume the office of the Moderator of the General Assembly in the next annual meeting.

5. The Recording Clerk

- 5-1 The Recording Clerk shall be responsible in recording, keeping and maintaining all the records of the meetings of the General Assembly.
- 5-2 He shall serve a term of *one (1) year and shall be eligible for re-election according to the pleasure of the General Assembly.* (BOG 19.4)
- 5-3 *He shall also serve as the secretary of the Corporation.*
- 5-4 *The duties of the Recording Clerk DURING the Assembly shall be to:*
 - 5-4.1 *Always have a copy at hand of the following documents for reference and guide during deliberations:*
 - a. *The Westminster Standards (the Confession of Faith, the Larger Catechism and the Shorter Catechism)*
 - b. *The GAPCP Book of Church Order (Form of Government, Directory of Worship and The Book of Discipline)*
 - c. *Standing Rules of GAPCP*
 - d. *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised (current edition)*
 - 5-4.2 *Form a complete roll of the members present, and put the same into the hands of the Moderator.*
 - 5-4.3 *Add to the roll the names of additional members of the Assembly when they indicate to him their presence in the Assembly.*
 - 5-4.4 *File all papers, with proper endorsements, and deliver them to the committees to which they were referred to by the actions of the Assembly.*

- 5-4.5 *Keep record of the docket as progressively amended.*
- 5-4.6 *Advise the Moderator on Parliamentary Procedures.*
- 5-4.7 *Shall appoint for that General Assembly an Assistant Recording Clerk to help him take down the minutes and whose task ceases with the adjournment of that Assembly.*
- 5-4.8 *The Assembly shall approve the Minutes of the Assembly, therefore the Recording Clerk shall be responsible to read each day's Minutes for the corrections. The corrected Minutes of the Assembly shall be approved and accepted by the Body before declaration of dissolution of the Assembly.*

5-5 *The duties of the Recording Clerk BETWEEN Assemblies:*

- 5-5.1 *Record and preserve the minutes of the meeting of the General Assembly and present them for approval by the Assembly at the next stated meeting.*
- 5-5.2 *Distribute the minutes of the immediate past meeting of the General Assembly to all Ministers, elders, Presbytery officers and chairmen of committees within 30 days following the General Assembly.*
- 5-5.3 *To inform promptly all persons and judicatories of the actions of the Assembly which directly affect them.*
- 5-5.4 *To advise Clerks of presbyteries of the obligation of presbyteries to present their records to the Assembly for review.*
- 5-5.5 *To receive reports of Standing and Special Committees, overtures, papers, requests, complaints, appeals, and any other communications intended for the next Assembly, for inclusion in a printed Agenda and presentation to the Assembly.*
- 5-5.6 *Prepare the docket of each meeting in cooperation with the General Secretary and the Moderator, and distribute it to all Ministers and elders at least 15 days prior to the meeting.*
- 5-5.7 *Handle the General Assembly's correspondence and records, forwarding information as appropriate to the committees of the Assembly.*
- 5-5.8 *Request data for, and publish at the stated meeting of the General Assembly, a directory of churches, Ministers, Elders and General Assembly Committees, listing the names, addresses, telephone numbers and email addresses of all churches, Ministers and Elders.*
- 5-5.9 *Receive and process the annual statistical reports to the Executive Committee and prepare a summary of the reports to be presented in the coming Assembly.*
- 5-5.10 *Make such computations to determine the number of commissioners per Presbytery for the membership of the next General Assembly and to inform the Presbyteries as to the results.*
- 5-5.11 *To act as Historian and be in charge of the past and current records of the church and keep all official papers in a permanent file available for inspection at the office of the denomination.*
- 5-5.12 *To regularly publish the Book of Church Order especially when amendments are made and to include in this the date and items amended.*
- 5-5.13 *Act for the treasurer during those times that the treasurer cannot perform the duties of his office.*

- 5-6 *The qualifications for the person to fill the office of the Recording Clerk shall be as follows:*
- 5-6.1 *He must be either a Minister or an Elder in the General Assembly of the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines.*
 - 5-6.2 *He must be conversant with the history and distinctives of the Presbyterian and Reformed tradition and in particular of the history and distinctives of GAPCP.*
 - 5-6.3 *He must have a competent knowledge of the standards of GAPCP.*
 - 5-6.4 *He must be loyal to the standards of GAPCP and be able to fairly represent the action of the General Assembly*
 - 5-6.5 *He must be able to work in a capable, sensitive, manner with persons who are of responsibility in the GAPCP organization structure.*
- 5-7 *At the minimum, the minutes of the General Assembly shall reflect the following:*
- 5-7.1 *Kind of meeting – Stated or Called, and the number of the stated meeting*
 - 5-7.2 *Time, date and place of meeting.*
 - 5-7.3 *Names of Minister and Elder commissioners attending.*
 - 5-7.4 *Name of Moderator and Clerk, and if present.*
 - 5-7.5 *Declaration of quorum.*
 - 5-7.6 *Meetings opened and closed with prayer and by whom.*
 - 5-7.7 *If Stated, reading and approval of minutes of previous meetings.*
 - 5-7.8 *Accurate record of all actions taken by motion, seconded and carried. An accurate record of the number of votes for or against a motion, where applicable. Actions may be taken by common consent if there is no objection.*
 - 5-7.9 *Time of adjournment.*
 - 5-7.10 *Minutes signed by the Clerk (the person who recorded the minutes of the meeting)*

6. The Treasurer

- 6-1 *The Treasurer shall have charge of the funds, receipts and disbursements of the GAPCP monies prescribed by the General Assembly budget.*
- 6-2 *He shall serve a term of one (1) year, and shall be eligible to be elected a second time after which he shall rest a term before being eligible to be elected.*
- 6-3 *He shall also serve as the Chief Financial Officer of the Corporation.*
- 6-4 *The duties of the Treasurer shall be as follows:*
 - 6-4.1 *Be the primary person to receive, record, and acknowledge all funds contributed to the General Assembly as directed by the Assembly. In the absence of the Treasurer and Clerk, the General Secretary shall have the authority to receive, record, and acknowledge funds.*

- 6-4.2 *Disburse funds as directed by the Assembly as directed by the chairmen of the Committees of the General Assembly in compliance with the budget of the committee.*
 - 6-4.3 *Prepare reports of the financial condition of the General Assembly for the annual stated meeting either in person or by a person he designates to report in his place.*
 - 6-4.4 *Submit the books of the General Assembly to the auditor for auditing.*
 - 6-4.5 *Be an automatic member of the Finance Committee.*
 - 6-4.6 *Shall appoint an Assistant Treasurer to help him for the duration of that General Assembly only.*
- 7. *The outgoing officers of the executive committee of the General Assembly shall turn over all documents and materials pertaining to their office to their respective successors upon election. There shall be a transition period of one (1) month wherein the outgoing officers shall be responsible in training their respective successors to be familiar with the documents, activities, and responsibilities of their office.*
 - 8. *The outgoing officers of the executive committee shall acquire a certificate of clearance from other members of the Executive Committee upon the end of his term.*
 - 9. *Any officer of the General Assembly may be impeached or relieved from office if found guilty of acts that are inconsistent with and contrary to the general welfare of the Church.*
 - 10. *No person shall be impeached or relieved from the office without due process as described in the Book of Discipline provided in the standards of the GAPCP.*

ARTICLE VI ELECTION OF THE OFFICERS

- 1. *Every Presbytery shall submit to the Recording Clerk of the General Assembly the names of candidates for the offices of the Executive Committee of the General Assembly thirty (30) days before the Annual Stated Meeting.*
- 2. *In the course of the General Assembly meeting, the nomination committee consisting of Moderators of Presbyteries or the Presbytery's duly appointed representative shall meet and collate the Presbyteries' submitted candidates for the offices of the General Assembly, the result of which they will submit to the GA Recording Clerk for presentation to the Assembly. They shall make sure no unqualified person is included as candidate.*
- 3. *The election of officers of the General Assembly shall proceed as follows:*
 - 3-1 *For each office of the Executive Committee of the General Assembly, the Moderator shall first present the list of nominees given by the nomination committee then the floor shall be opened for additional nominees. If there be no more nominations, the Moderator shall close the nominations.*
 - 3-2 *There shall be only one nominating speech per nominee not to exceed five minutes for each nominee. No seconding speech shall be permitted.*
 - 3-3 *Election shall begin with a prayer and shall proceed by ballot provided by the Recording Clerk of the General Assembly. Tellers appointed by the Recording Clerk of the Assembly shall gather, count and report the ballot tabulation to the Recording Clerk of the Assembly. The simple majority of delegates present in the annual General Assembly meeting shall elect the officers.*

- 3-4 *Should no majority exist among a plurality of nominees, the lowest nominees shall be dropped and a second ballot shall be called for the two highest nominees, the highest of which will be elected into office. The Moderator shall then declare the election.*
- 3-5 *If there be only one nominee, a motion for a voice vote to elect by acclamation shall be in order.*
- 3-6 *This procedure shall be done to elect, on their proper schedules, a Vice-Moderator, a Recording Clerk, a Treasurer, and a General Secretary, in that order. The retiring Vice-Moderator shall then assume his duties as the new Moderator.*
- 3-7 *A turnover ceremony will commence to initiate the new officers to their duties.*

ARTICLE VII AUDITOR

1. The body shall elect an Auditor.

- 1-1 *The Auditor shall carefully check the accuracy of business records and ensure that the organization is maintaining accurate and honest financial records and statements.*
- 1-2 *He shall be an automatic member of the Financial Committee.*
- 1-3 *The duties of the Auditor shall be to:*
 - 1-3.1 *Receive, examine and investigate all accounting documents (recording ledgers, bank books, bank records, bank statements, vouchers, receipts and Assembly disbursements) of the Treasurer and other persons at regular intervals and especially the end of each budget year (October).*
 - 1-3.2 *Reconcile year-end accounting records and financial statements.*
 - 1-3.3 *Verify cash balances on the year-end financial statements are the same as in the accounting records and reconcile with the year-end bank statement.*
 - 1-3.4 *Submit a report to the General Assembly each year.*
 - 1-3.5 *Submit a copy of the Auditor's Report to the Executive Committee of the General Assembly prior to the Assembly's next session.*
- 1-4 *He shall serve for one (1) year and shall not be part of the Executive Officers.*

ARTICLE VIII ORGANIZING THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY MEETING

1. Registration and Seating

- 1-1 *The Recording Clerk and Treasurer, alongside others they may designate, shall enroll delegates on the opening of the General Assembly, and at such other times as may be necessary, and they shall give all prepared documents for commissioners immediately*

after registering. Any questions that may arise regarding registration of delegates shall be determined by the Executive Committee.

- 1-2 The Recording Clerk shall assign the delegates their seats by Presbytery before the commencement of the meeting. The delegates shall occupy their assigned seats for the duration of the transaction of the General Assembly.*
- 1-3 When a principal delegate is replaced by a Presbytery-approved alternate prior to or during the course of an assembly session, whether for the remainder of the session or for a period of time during the session, the alternate shall assume his space assignments.*
- 1-4 All guests are invited to register and be seated in their assigned area as visiting brothers.*

2. Worship

- 2-1 The General Assembly shall provide adequate time for the delegates to corporately engage in worship, prayer and the study of the Word of God, and fellowship.*
- 2-1 The General Assembly shall begin at the designated time for the worship service, which includes singing, a season of prayer, a sermon or exhortation given by the outgoing Moderator, and the celebration of the Lord's Supper. A recess may appropriately be called after the worship, otherwise the Assembly may proceed with opening the meeting.*

3. Opening the Meeting

- 3-1 After the initial proceedings, the national anthem shall be sung, then the Moderator shall call the members into order and the Recording Clerk shall present a report on the enrollment of commissioners and declare if there is a quorum. If there be a quorum the Assembly shall be declared properly constituted and the meeting shall be opened with a prayer.*
- 3-2 The Moderator shall then proceed with the adoption of the docket by a majority vote of the Assembly which may be amended at any time by a two-thirds (2/3) vote, and with its adoption, progress with the order of business.*
- 3-3 If a quorum be not assembled at the hour appointed, all means shall be procured to obtain a quorum. If it persists that a quorum be not assembled, the Assembly can only determine the date and place for another meeting and the Moderator shall adjourn the meeting.*
- 3-4 In the absence of the Moderator, the Vice-Moderator shall open the meeting with a sermon and preside. In the absence of both the Moderator and the Vice-Moderator, the Recording Clerk shall preside in place of the Moderator until a temporary Moderator for that meeting is elected. In the absence of all three preceding officers, the Treasurer shall preside in place of the Moderator until a temporary Moderator for that meeting is elected.*
- 3-5 The Moderator shall be active in helping each matter, which was brought to the attention of the General Assembly, to a responsible and expeditious conclusion. He may delegate his chair to the Vice-Moderator as need may arise.*

4. Communications and Overtures

- 4-1 *A communication to the General Assembly is a formal correspondence received by the Recording Clerk of the General Assembly from other churches, inter-church agencies and from other organized bodies outside the church proper having business with the Assembly. The Recording Clerk of the General Assembly shall recommend to the Assembly reference for all communications.*
- 4-2 *An overture is the request of a Presbytery or a Committee of the Assembly for action by the General Assembly upon a specific matter.*
- 4-3 *All overtures of Presbyteries shall be delivered to the Recording Clerk of the General Assembly at least twenty-one (21) days prior to the opening of the General Assembly. No overtures of Presbyteries received by the Recording Clerk of the General Assembly shall be considered by its Assembly convening in that year. Overtures from the floor of the General Assembly shall be considered only if received by a 2/3 vote of assembled Commissioners. Overtures of the reorganized Standing Committees shall be accepted from the floor of the Assembly.*
- 4-4 *All overtures from Presbyteries and Committees shall be taken up and disposed of in a section of the agenda called Overtures.*

5. Reports to the General Assembly

- 5-1 *The General Secretary, Treasurer, presbyteries, standing committees and any special committees shall make annual reports. Such reports shall be transmitted to the Recording Clerk of the General Assembly thirty (30) days before the General Assembly. Otherwise a report may only be presented if a committee representative first explains the delay and then, without debate, the Assembly, by a simple majority, agrees to hear the report.*
- 5-2 *Each presbytery and committee report shall be limited to ten minutes. The time limit for any presentation or report may be extended for an additional five-minutes by a simple majority vote of the General Assembly.*
- 5-3 *In presenting a report, the speaker shall lead the Assembly in a brief prayer before giving the report. The entire report shall be read before any comment. The Assembly may waive the reading of any particular report by a majority vote of the commissioners present.*
- 5-4 *When a minority of the committee wishes to present a minority report the member reporting for the minority shall have the privilege of presenting the minority report and moving it as a substitute for the portion of the majority report affected.*
- 5-5 *Recommendations and motions of the committee arising from the report shall be disposed of in a section of the agenda called Overtures. The reports are not to be approved or adopted but rather filed in the following manner:*
 - 5-5.1 *The Moderator moves the filing of the report by asking "Is there any question to the report?"*
 - 5-5.2 *If there are no objection or further questions the Moderator says, "Hearing no objection the report is now filed." (Procedure known as "Short Form of Voting").*

6. Presbytery Minutes

- 6-1 *All presbyteries shall submit their minutes to the GA Executive Committee at least 21 days before the General Assembly meeting. Presbyteries failing to submit their Minutes on time shall be fined by an amount determined by the Financial Committee.*
- 6-2 *Each set of Presbytery Minutes must be read and notated by the members of the GA Executive Committee*
- 6-3 *Presbytery Minutes shall be examined for conformity to:*
- 6-3.1 *The constitutional standards of the GAPCP, as to substance of action recorded;*
 - 6-3.2 *Appropriate standards as to the use of the English or Filipino language.*
- 6-4 *The findings of the Executive Committee with respect to the Minutes of the Presbytery shall be reported under the following categories as appropriate:*
- 6-4.1 *Notations: Typographical errors, misspellings, improper punctuation, non-prejudicial statements of facts and other variations in form may be reported here. Also, failure to provide sufficient or proper information or identification, misstatement of facts, etc., may be included here.*
 - 6-4.2 *Notations requiring response: Insufficient information in the Minutes to determine if an action is constitutional. Such notations are not read to the General Assembly but require a written response of the presbytery to the Executive Committee.*
 - 6-4.3 *Exceptions: Violations of constitutional standards of actions which in substance appear not to conform to GAPCP standards, and prejudicial misstatements of facts should be reported here.*
- 6-5 *The Executive Committee shall prepare a report and their corresponding recommendations concerning the Minutes of each Presbytery. After action by the Assembly, two copies shall be given to the Recording Clerk, one for his permanent file and one to be mailed to the Recording Clerk of the Presbytery.*
- 6-6 *Notations and exceptions in the Committee's report shall be handled as follows:*
- 6-6.1 *Notations shall be forwarded to the Recording Clerk of the Presbytery without being read to the Assembly or recorded in its Minutes.*
 - 6-6.2 *Exceptions shall be read before the Assembly, recorded in its Minutes, and disposed of as the Assembly determines.*
- 6-7 *The Presbyteries shall take note in their Minutes of exceptions and notations conveyed from the Assembly and of the disposition they have made of such.*
- 6-8 *Guidelines for Presbytery Minutes. At the minimum, the minutes of the Presbytery shall reflect the following:*
- 6-8.1 *Date, time, place of meeting, Presbytery must meet two (2) times a year. Presbytery review year shall include those minutes approved by Presbytery October to the October next year of each Assembly year. Minutes should reflect the names of Ruling and Teaching Elders present, visitors present, and include excused and unexcused absences. Minutes should reflect the number of the stated meeting.*
 - 6-8.2 *Meeting opened and closed with prayer.*
 - 6-8.3 *Declaration of quorum*

- 6-8.4 *Accurate record of motions passed and actions taken.*
- 6-8.5 *Minutes should be typed with complete sentences, correct spelling and bound in an appropriate cover.*
- 6-8.6 *Minutes should be signed by Recording Clerk and Moderator.*
- 6-8.7 *Minutes should reflect an accurate record of candidates received and dismissed.*
- 6-8.8 *Minutes should reflect an accurate record of ministers received and dismissed including proper examination procedures leading to ordination and/or installation.*
- 6-8.9 *Record of approved pastoral calls and any changes in calls and the granting of permission to labor outside the bounds of Presbytery.*
- 6-8.10 *Minutes must reflect an annual review of sessional records.*
- 6-8.11 *Minutes must reflect establishing, dissolving, dividing, uniting, receiving, and dismissing of churches.*
- 6-8.12 *Minutes must reflect observations of and carrying out of General Assembly injunctions and instructions.*
- 6-8.13 *Overtures to the General Assembly must be recorded.*
- 6-8.14 *Minutes will reflect any judicial cases before Presbytery and the disposition thereof in accordance with the Book of Discipline.*
- 6-8.15 *Minutes will include all actions of Presbytery appointed commissions.*
- 6-8.16 *Minutes should include annual approved Presbytery budget and related financial reports*

ARTICLE IX STANDING COMMITTEES

1. The Standing Committees of the General Assembly shall be composed of the following:

- 1-1 Executive Committee
- 1-2 Mission Committee
- 1-3 Theological Education Committee
- 1-4 Christian Education Committee
- 1-5 Diaconal and Ministerial Welfare Committee
- 1-6 Church Auxiliaries Committee
- 1-7 Publication Committee
- 1-8 Finance Committee
- 1-9 Judicial Court

2. Election and Term of Members.

- 2-1 The members of the Standing Committees shall be recommended by the Executive Committee two weeks prior to the opening of the General Assembly meeting.
- 2-2 The GA shall act on the recommendation right after resuming the first session of the meeting. The Body shall approve the nominees.

- 2-3 The tenure of committee members shall be three (3) years. New members shall replace one-third of the committee members every year.
- 2-4 The committee members shall not be eligible for reappointment to their respective committees until one year has elapsed.
- 2-5 Each Standing Committee shall be called the first meeting for the organizing by the oldest member who has only one year to serve, and he shall serve until a new chairman be elected.
- 2-6 The Chairman of a committee must have been a member of the particular committee for not less than one year

3. Duties

3-1 The Executive Committee shall have the following duties :

- 3-1.1 To execute all the matters entrusted by the body.
- 3-1.2 To receive and classify overtures, bills and documents from Presbyteries and distribute them to the relevant Standing Committees.
- 3-1.3 To prepare all matters for opening of the General Assembly Meeting.
- 3-1.4 To examine and order to correct the minutes of Presbyteries.
- 3-1.5 *To review, give recommendations and provide structure, order, and continuity in reviewing Minutes of the Presbyteries.*
- 3-1.6 *To represent the denomination*

3-2 The Mission Committee shall have the following duties :

- 3-2.1 To make programs and policies concerning both home and foreign mission.
- 3-2.2 To monitor ongoing mission works of *GAPCP*.
- 3-2.3 To examine and commission missionary candidates.
- 3-2.4 To raise funds for mission-related programs
- 3-2.5 To promote mission awareness among the particular Churches within the bounds of *GAPCP*.
- 3-2.6 *Make recommendations for strategic target areas for church planting.*
- 3-2.7 *Stimulate Presbyteries and churches to develop daughter churches.*
- 3-2.8 *Develop, encourage, coordinate and provide resources and programs to promote church planting, evangelism and church vitality and development efforts of Presbyteries and churches.*

3-3 The Theological Education Committee shall have the following duties :

- 3-3.1 To set standards and policies concerning theological institutions that are within the bounds of *GAPCP*.
- 3-3.2 To recommend to theological institutions curriculum for training ministerial candidates.

- 3-3.3 To set-up scholarship program for Ministerial candidates and supervise their educational performance and spiritual maturity by corresponding with our denomination's theological seminary.
- 3-3.4 To regulate and supervise all theological institutions.
- 3-3.5 To receive the results of the comprehensive examination conducted by the PTS [and other accredited seminaries] as required by the *GAPCP* Standards for all candidates who graduated from the Presbyterian Theological Seminary-Philippines [and other accredited seminaries] for licentiates and candidates for ordination
- 3-3.6 To turnover the results of the examination to respective Presbyteries for further examination for the ordination to the ministry.
- 3-3.7 *To receive and study such theological matters as may be referred to it by the General Assembly and to return to the General Assembly its opinion and requested papers or documents*
- 3-3.8 *Consider moral and ethical issues that affect the churches of the General Assembly at large and ensure that the General Assembly address erroneous opinions which injure the purity or peace of the Church.*

3-4 The Christian Education Committee shall have the following duties :

- 3-4.1 To formulate policies concerning Christian Education.
- 3-4.2 *To develop and evaluate curriculum for presbyteries and local churches as needed.*
- 3-4.3 To publish Christian Education-related materials.
- 3-4.4 To develop curriculum for Sunday School, VBS and Christian Day School.
- 3-4.5 To formulate budget for the educational work of the denomination.
- 3-4.6 To organize seminars, workshops and other activities that promote skills and knowledge in Christian Education.
- 3-4.7 *To promote and evaluate prayer, worship and music resources.*
- 3-4.8 *To participate in and support lay leadership development.*
- 3-4.9 *To facilitate the churches' ability to share resources, training opportunities and joint ministry opportunities for areas of educational ministry which the churches have in common.*
- 3-4.10 *Act as a repository and channel for materials and resources for churches that are seeking help in the area of educational ministry.*

3-5 The Diaconal and Ministerial Welfare Committee shall have the following duties:

- 3-5.1 To formulate programs and policies for relief and disaster assistance.
- 3-5.2 To raise fund for relief works.
- 3-5.3 To co-ordinate with the Presbyteries medical/dental outreach programs.
- 3-5.4 To formulate retirement program for Ministers.
- 3-5.5 To formulate policies concerning Ministerial Welfare programs.
- 3-5.6 To support Ministers who do not have pastoral charge.
- 3-5.7 To help families of deceased Ministers.

3-5.8 To establish and supervise retreat centers for Ministers and other workers of *GAPCP*.

3-5.9 *To monitor and aid ministerial committees of local presbyteries*

3-6 The Auxiliaries Committee shall have the following duties :

3-6.1 To supervise and vitalize the national organizations of Youth, Men, and Women.

3-6.2 To co-ordinate national camps, conventions and other similar gatherings.

3-6.3 To appoint directors of camps, conventions and other similar gatherings.

3-7 The Publication Committee shall have the following duties :

1-4.1 To oversee and publish all materials as may be required by the General Assembly.

1-4.2 To supervise the distribution of the publications.

1-4.3 *Manage and maintain the official website of the General Assembly.*

1-4.4 *To help communicate the identity, vision, mission, and advantages of GAPCP to local churches and to those outside of the denomination.*

3-8 The Finance Committee shall have the following duties :

3-8.1 To formulate an annual budget based on the submitted budget of different committees for General Assembly approval.

3-8.2 To designate the amount of due to the Presbyteries for the fiscal year during the General assembly Meeting.

3-8.3 To monitor income and expenditures of the *GAPCP*.

3-8.4 To recommend to the General Assembly financial policies for *GAPCP*.

3-8.5 To appoint an independent auditor for the annual financial review.

3-8.6 To designate the amount of due to the Presbyteries for the fiscal year during the General Assembly Meeting.

3-8.7 *To conduct fund-raising activities for the General Assembly in coordination with the Executive Committee.*

3-9 The Judicial Court shall have the following duties :

3-9.1 To handle all judicial matters during and after dissolving the General Assembly Meeting.

3-9.2 To make a report on the results to the next General Assembly Meeting and inform the result to the lower judicatory or individual who appealed to the General Assembly.

ARTICLE X SPECIAL COMMITTEES

1. *The Assembly may elect or appoint special committees of a temporary character to handle or expedite particular matters of business as designated by the General Assembly and shall be dissolved upon the accomplishment of the work entrusted to them by the Body.*

ARTICLE XI SEMINARY TRUSTEES

1. The Theological Education Committee Chairman and the General Secretary shall be members of the Board of Trustees of all Seminaries and Bible Schools under the GAPCP. The Trustees shall be responsible for operating the seminary/Bible School with other members of BOT according to its BY-LAWS.

ARTICLE XII FINANCES

1. The operation of the General Assembly and the GAPCP shall be dependent on the dues of Presbyteries and voluntary donations of individuals and other agencies.
2. The particular churches shall be responsible for the travel expenses of their delegates to the General Assembly. Particular churches that cannot support their delegates may submit a letter of request for subsidy.
3. The GAPCP shall be responsible for the travel expenses and honoraria of individuals who are attending committee meetings, hearings, and other meetings in their official capacity.
4. The Standard of compensation and of the full-time staff and personnel of the GAPCP office shall be approved by the General Assembly.

ARTICLE XIII CORPORATE

1. *There shall be a corporation known as The General Assembly of the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines, registered for the purpose of conducting its temporal affairs, as a non-stock, non-profit and religious organization in accordance with the laws of the Republic of the Philippines.*
2. *The Board of Trustees shall be composed of 12 members, of which the Executive Committee, namely the General Secretary, Moderator, Vice-Moderator, Recording Clerk, and the Treasurer are automatic members of the said board. The Moderator shall serve as the president or chairman, the Vice-Moderator as the Vice-president or Vice-chairman, the Recording Clerk as the corporate secretary, the Treasurer as the Chief Financial Officer and the General Secretary as a member of the said board. The General Assembly shall elect from the Moderators of Presbyteries the remaining 7 members of the Board of trustees.*
3. *Duties of the Board of Trustees:*
 - 3-1 *The duties of the Board of Trustees shall only be those delegated by the General Assembly.*
 - 3-2 *The Board of Trustees shall report annually the following:*

- 3-2.1 Statement of income and expenses of the precious fiscal year.*
- 3-2.2 Estimate of income and expenses for the following fiscal year.*
- 3-2.3 An exhibit of real properties, trust funds and other resources of the Church.*
- 3-2.4 New business necessary to be undertaken for the welfare of the church.*

4. Corporation Meeting:

- 4-1 The annual meeting of the corporation shall be the same as the meeting of the General Assembly.*
- 4-2 The meeting shall be chaired by the presiding officer and recorded by the secretary.*

**ARTICLE XIV
FISCAL YEAR**

- 1. The fiscal year of the corporation shall be from the first day of January to the last day of December of each year.*

**ARTICLE XV
CORPORATE SEAL**

- 1. The corporate seal of the corporation shall be such form and design as may be determined by the Board of Trustees.*

**ARTICLES XVI
OFFICIAL RECORDS AND FORMS**

- 1. The Official records of the *GAPCP* shall comprise the following:
 - 1-1 Personal record of all Ministers
 - 1-2 List and profile of particular churches
 - 1-3 List of organized churches
 - 1-4 List of vacant churches
 - 1-5 List of newly planted churches
 - 1-6 List of dissolved churches
 - 1-7 Directory of Ministers and Missionaries
 - 1-8 Directory of Elders
 - List of dismissed churches
 - 1-9 List of dismissed Ministers/Missionaries
 - 1-10 List of Licentiates and Ministerial Candidates
 - 1-11 List of deceased Ministers, Elders, and Missionaries
 - 1-12 List of properties
 - 1-13 Financial Records

- 1-14 List profile of Presbyteries
 - 1-15 List of past officers of the General Assembly
 - 1-16 Record of Examinations
Minutes of the General Assembly
 - 1-17 Judicial records
 - 1-18 List of annual statistics baptized members of *GAPCP*
 - 1-19 List profile of institutions
 - 1-20 List of inactive Ministers
 - 1-21 List of resigned Ministers, Licentiates, and Ministerial Candidates
2. The personal and ministerial activity records of all Ministers shall be updated every year.
 3. All official records, Minutes, correspondence and other pertinent documents shall be kept at the principal office of the *GAPCP*.
 4. All record, Minutes, correspondences and other pertinent documents, except those that are classified as "confidential" or similar to it, shall be accessible to any member for inspection. Reproduction in any form of records, Minutes, correspondences and other pertinent documents shall be subjects to the approval of the General Secretary.

ARTICLE XVII PARLIAMENTARY PROCEDURES

1. *Except as otherwise specifically provided in these Standing Rules and not inconsistent with the Constitution of the Presbyterian Church of the Philippines, the current edition of Robert's Rules of Order shall be the standard parliamentary procedure.*
2. *Special Rules of the Assembly*
 - 2-1 *No delegates shall be allowed to speak on the floor unless acknowledge by the Moderator.*
 - 2-2 *Each delegate shall be limited to two (2) speeches per motion. A delegate's first speech shall be limited to not more than five (5) minutes and the second to not more than three (3) minutes.*
 - 2-3 *No person who is not an official delegate of Assembly shall be allowed to participate in the floor deliberations unless otherwise approved by the body by a two-thirds (2/3) vote.*
 - 2-4 *In presenting the report of a committee, each chairman or his designate shall lead the Assembly in a brief prayer before making the report. The entire report shall be presented before any comment.*
 - 2-5 *A motion for a recess shall not require deliberation.*
 - 2-6 *Postponement of certain matters to the next Assembly must be sought rather than arriving at a decision, not well thought out, or of questionable value.*
 - 2-7 *If the Assembly is sitting in judicial capacity, the Body may move to suspend some of the above rules as may be deemed necessary.*

3. Procedure in Debating a question :

- 3-1 *The chairman or his designate may answer questions concerning the report addressed to him through the Moderator.*
- 3-2 *With respect to any recommendation, the representative of any Committee shall have the right to make the final speech in support of the Committee's motion before the question is put on vote.*
- 3-3 *No commissioner may speak on the same question more than once until all desiring to speak have done so.*
- 3-4 *Debate shall be free and open, with equal time being given to proponents and opponents insofar as possible.*

**ARTICLE XVIII
SUSPENSION OF RULES & AMENDMENTS**

1. SUSPENSION OF STANDING RULES:

- 1-1** *The Standing Rules may be temporarily suspended upon motion, by affirmative vote of three-fourths (3/4) of the representatives present and voting except those that are related to either the Constitution of GAPCP (Westminster Standards) or the Standards of GAPCP (The Form of Government, Book of Discipline and Directory for the Public Worship of God. The suspension shall only be for that Assembly meeting. A motion to suspend is not debatable.*

2. AMENDMENTS TO THE STANDING RULES

- 2-1 *The Standing Rules may be amended only if the amendment is first proposed in writing at a stated meeting of the General Assembly.*
- 2-2 *The Standing Rules may only be amended or repealed by a three-fourths (3/4) vote of the total enrollment of the Commissioners of the General Assembly except those that are related to either the Constitution of GAPCP (Westminster Standards) or the Standards of GAPCP (The Form of Government, Book of Discipline and Directory for the Public Worship of God).*
- 2-3 *A motion to amend is debatable.*

3. AMENDMENTS TO THE STANDARDS OF GAPCP: *Amendments to the Form of Government, Directory of Public Worship and Book of Discipline may be made only in the following manner:*

- 3-1 *All proposals requesting amendments to the Standards of GAPCP, namely the Form of Government, Directory of Worship and Book of Discipline, shall be communicated in writing to the Recording Clerk of the General Assembly no later than 30 days prior to the convening of the next General Assembly. The Recording Clerk shall refer all such proposed amendments to the Executive Committee of the General Assembly, which shall examine the proposed amendments for clarity and consistency of language and for compatibility with other provisions of GAPCP. The Executive Committee shall report its findings to the General Assembly along with its recommendations. Which may include an amended version of any changes as well as advice to accept or decline the proposals referred to the Executive Committee. The General Assembly shall not consider any amendment until there is a report from the Executive Committee.*

- 3-2 *The General Assembly shall then determine whether a suggested change is worthy of consideration. If so determined, that assembly may then propose the amendment to the presbyteries by a two-thirds (2/3) majority of the members voting.*
 - 3-3 *Approval by a presbytery shall then be by a majority of the members voting, and following this decision the clerk of presbytery shall notify the clerk of the assembly, in writing, of the decision of the presbytery.*
 - 3-4 *If two-thirds of the presbyteries approve the amendment it shall be brought to the next ensuing assembly and finally adopted only after approval of the assembly by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the members present and voting.*
 - 3-5 *If, however, by the subsequent General Assembly, an insufficient number of Presbyteries has voted, the Assembly shall urge those Presbyteries to vote. If by the second Assembly following original enactment, an insufficient number of Presbyteries has given the amendment a majority vote, it shall be declared lost.*
 - 3-6 *No changes may be made to the Standards of GAPCP that would be contrary to the Confession of Faith and Catechisms.*
 - 3-7 *These provisions can be amended only by the same method it prescribed for amendments to the standards of GAPCP.*
4. **AMENDMENTS TO THE CONFESSION OF FAITH & CATECHISMS, AND OF FORMS OF GAPCP:**
Amendments or alterations of the Confession of Faith and Catechisms, and of forms of subscriptions required of ministers, licentiates elders and deacons as these are found in the Form of Government may be made only in the following manner :
- 4-1 *All proposals requesting amendments to the Confession of Faith and Catechisms, and of forms of GAPCP shall be communicated in writing to the Recording Clerk of the General Assembly no later than 30 days prior to the convening of the next General Assembly. The Recording Clerk shall refer all such proposed amendments to the Executive Committee of the General Assembly, which shall examine the proposed amendments for clarity and consistency of language and for compatibility with other provisions of GAPCP. The Executive Committee shall report its findings to the General Assembly along with its recommendations. Which may include an amended version of any changes as well as advice to accept or decline the proposals referred to the Executive Committee. The General Assembly shall not consider any amendment until there is a report from the Executive Committee.*
 - 4-3 *The General Assembly shall then determine whether a suggested change is worthy of consideration by a two-thirds (2/3) majority vote. If so determined, it shall appoint a special committee to consider any suggested change and to report to the next regular assembly with recommendations; that assembly may then propose the amendment to the presbyteries by a two-thirds majority of the members voting.*
 - 4-4 *Approval by a presbytery shall then be by a majority of the members voting, and following this decision the clerk of presbytery shall notify the clerk of the assembly, in writing, of the decision of the presbytery.*
 - 4-4 *If two-thirds of the presbyteries approve the amendment it shall be adopted finally only after approval of the next ensuing assembly by a two-thirds vote of the members present and voting.*
 - 4-5 *If, however, by the subsequent General Assembly, an insufficient number of Presbyteries has voted, the Assembly shall urge those Presbyteries to vote. If by the second Assembly following original enactment, an insufficient number of Presbyteries has given the amendment a majority vote, it shall be declared lost.*

- 4-6 *These provisions can be amended only by the same method it prescribed for amendments to the confessional documents.*

ARTICLE XIX TRANSITORY ARTICLES

1. ON QUORUM IN THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY:

- 1-2** *While the number of Elders is presently insufficient to guarantee equal representation in the judicatories, the quorum of the General Assembly shall be declared when twenty or more delegates are present, 17 of which are ministers and 3 are elders.*
- 1-3** *This transitory provision shall be revoked when the conditions of Article 3.3 are met, by a vote of simple majority and shall consequently be removed from the Standing Rules of the GAPCP*

2. ON MEMBERSHIP TO THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY:

- 2-1** *While there are pending unresolved matters regarding boundaries among Presbyteries and the matter of the true state of the count of baptized membership of each Presbytery, the General Assembly shall consist of all ministers and elders commissioned by their Presbytery regardless of the size of its baptized membership.*
- 2-2** *This transitory provision shall be revoked when the conditions of Chapter 11.2 of the Book of Government and Article 4-1 of this Standing Rules are met, such that (1) matters of Presbytery boundaries have been resolved and definitely drawn, and (2) the baptized membership of each Presbytery have been reasonably ascertained—and by a vote of simple majority shall consequently be removed from the Standing Rules of the GAPCP.*

** As amended during the 20th General Assembly Stated Meeting held in Iloilo City (October 22, 2015)*